Juan Carlos Munguia
CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT CONSULTING

CASE STUDY

Twelve months of coaching didn't move CSAT.

A 200-person division had missed its 78% satisfaction target for a full year. Every quarter the answer was the same: coach the agents harder.

0.93 vs 0.49

Correlation to CSAT: service level versus quality-monitoring score

24 to 48 h

Delay between the interaction and the survey being sent

70% to 90%

CSAT: twelve-month average (73% the month we started) to 90%, reached within a month

Juan Carlos Munguia · Organizational Psychology · PMP · Lean Six Sigma Master Black Belt
contact@jcmunguia.com · jcmunguia.com · linkedin.com/in/jc-munguia

The problem was not the people.

- A multiple-KPI regression showed satisfaction tracked **service level** (0.93), not the quality scores the coaching was built on (0.49).
- The survey fired 24 to 48 hours later. It measured how the customer felt the next day, not the service they received.
- Agents had no visible link between their own behaviour and the score they were being coached on.

The measurement was failing, not the service.

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Four moves.

1. Moved the survey trigger to the moment the agent releases the contact.
2. Built a release-rate control to close the gaming surface that change created.
3. Kept quality monitoring for coaching, and stopped using it as a predictor.
4. Certified the supervisors to own the indicator, with standard-work audits at 85% or better.

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Three rules.

1. Check the measurement before the people.
Most service problems that survive a year of coaching are measurement problems wearing a performance costume.

2. Find the driver, not the correlation you expected.
A regression across the full KPI set usually names a different culprit than the one the leadership team has been discussing.

3. Fix the system, then coach into it.
Close the gaming surface your own change creates, hand the indicator to the people who can move it, audit the standard work.

Results from an in-house role. Client, employer, industry and location withheld by agreement. Figures are as reported by the operation at the time.

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